he wants me to be 100% sure that his advice is motivated not by financial gain, but by what he genuinely believes is best for me.

He has always remained low profile; in fact, he does not want his name or his role to be included in this book, but his role – at least – is included on my insistence because he is part of my story.

As chairman, he assembled a professional support team, which met for the first time in February 2008, and which now meets every quarter, usually at the Investec offices on Atterbury Road in Pretoria.

Brendan Ross, a calm, knowledgeable and experienced Wealth Manager at Investec in Pretoria, agreed to deal with all the banking and investment issues. Johan Heunis, the respected former Northern Transvaal and Springbok fullback and partner at Heunis & Straeuli Attorneys, agreed to deal with legal issues, reviewing contracts; and Eben Gerryts, from PricewaterhouseCoopers, was asked to bring his broad experience in working with the likes of Ernie Els to assist me in dealing with tax and accounting issues.

Brendan, Johan and Eben were effectively installed as the three wise men, providing me with trusted, expert professional advice on every business proposal and investment. This structure meant I could stay detached from these decisions, and focus all my attention and energy on the game.

Millie de Villiers, my mother, who had been managing most of these tasks on her own up until this point, remained a key member of the team. Lindie Claassens, another outstanding professional from PricewaterhouseCoopers, was asked to manage my accounts, and Jacques Hugo, from Investec, expertly assisted with my investments. Lastly, it was agreed that I should appoint a personal assistant, who would deal with all correspondence and contracts, and generally make sure I was in the right place at the right time.

A search was launched and, following a series of interviews at the Daan Swiegers clubhouse on the University of Pretoria campus, Letitia